

THE IMBEWU INVESTIGATION

Week 3 — Store-Level Deep Dive

Western Cape · Individual Store Analysis · Dashboard Notes

1. New Stakeholder Request

Sizwe Khumalo • Head of Sales • Friday, Week 2 — 11:08

"Hi, quick update on what I'm hearing back from the regions.

The Western Cape Regional Manager pushed back on me yesterday. She says "Western Cape is too broad, we have 12 stores and they're not all the same." Fair point.

Can you make sure your analysis goes down to individual store level too? I don't want to say "WC is down" if it turns out to be 2 or 3 stores dragging the average. We need to know which stores.

Same deadline. Thanks!"

Response: This is a fair and important challenge. The Week 2 analysis already pointed to Mega-format stores as the primary driver — this week's work drills into each of the 12 WC stores individually to confirm exactly which stores are responsible for the decline and which are growing. The finding is striking: the revenue decline is not evenly distributed across WC. It is **concentrated in 3 specific stores**, while 4 stores are actively growing.

2. All 12 WC Stores — H1 Snapshot

The table below ranks all 12 Western Cape stores by H1 revenue change. H1 (January–June) is used for both years to ensure a like-for-like comparison.

Store Name	Format	H1 2024	H1 2025	Rev Δ	Visits Δ	
Imbewu Mega Bellville	Mega	R74,192	R55,365	-25.4%	-11.8%	↓
Imbewu Market Claremont	Market	R23,327	R20,090	-13.9%	-7.0%	↓
Imbewu Mega Paarl Central	Mega	R68,342	R60,079	-12.1%	-0.8%	↓
Imbewu Market George Central	Market	R26,822	R23,679	-11.7%	-5.1%	↓
Imbewu Express CBD	Express	R8,327	R7,373	-11.5%	-20.4%	↓
Imbewu Mega Tygervalley	Mega	R60,329	R56,211	-6.8%	0.0%	↓
Imbewu Mega Parow	Mega	R60,720	R61,255	+0.9%	+7.3%	→
Imbewu Express Constantia	Express	R9,315	R10,131	+8.8%	-22.6%	↑
Imbewu Market Stellenbosch Central	Market	R21,884	R24,173	+10.5%	+2.6%	↑
Imbewu Market Khayelitsha	Market	R22,903	R29,682	+29.6%	+20.3%	↑
Imbewu Express Sea Point	Express	R6,848	R9,020	+31.7%	0.0%	↑

Imbewu Express Mitchell's Plain	Express	R5,778	R8,186	+41.7%	+5.0%	
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Key finding: The WC decline is NOT a province-wide problem. It is driven by 3 specific Mega stores.

Declining stores: 6 stores declined, generating R38,543 of gross revenue loss.

Growing stores: 4 stores grew, generating R15,000 of offsetting gains.

Net WC decline: R23,543 — the visible gap Sizwe flagged.

Critical insight: The 3 Mega stores (Bellville, Paarl, Tygervalley) alone account for R31,209 of gross decline — 132.6% of the total net gap. Without them, WC would actually be growing, because the Express and Market stores are collectively up R15,000.

3. Deep Dive — Imbewu Mega Bellville (Worst Performer)

Mega Bellville is the single largest revenue problem in WC. It declined **-25.4%** in H1, losing R18,827 — more than the entire net WC gap on its own. This store requires immediate attention.

3.1 What Is Driving the Bellville Decline?

Category	H1 2024	H1 2025	Change (R)	Change (%)
Groceries	R39,298	R26,896	-R12,402	-31.6%
Household	R15,960	R12,133	-R3,827	-24.0%
Health & Beauty	R8,160	R7,077	-R1,083	-13.3%
Electronics	R3,205	R2,130	-R1,075	-33.6%
Apparel	R7,569	R7,129	-R440	-5.8%

3.2 Bellville Monthly Revenue Trend

The monthly data reveals that the decline is consistent and not explained by a single bad month:

Month	2024 Revenue	2025 Revenue	Δ Revenue	Avg Basket Δ
January	R12,662	R9,568	-R3,094	-27.8%
February	R12,470	R6,520	-R5,950	-31.3%
March	R14,241	R10,388	-R3,853	-16.6%
April	R12,162	R8,085	-R4,077	-15.0%
May	R13,564	R11,590	-R1,974	-3.4%
June	R9,093	R9,214	+R121	+6.5%

- February 2025 was the worst month (-R5,950 vs Feb 2024) — a 45-day period where basket size dropped 31.3%. This is not a seasonal effect.
- May 2025 showed improvement (-R1,974 vs May 2024 vs -R5,950 in February). June 2025 turned slightly positive — a possible early sign of recovery.
- The average basket at Bellville dropped from R545.53 to R461.37 (-15.4%). Customers are visiting less AND spending less per trip.

- Groceries alone (–R12,402) accounts for 65.8% of Bellville's total revenue decline. This strongly points to a local competitive threat — a competitor likely opened in the Bellville area drawing staple grocery shoppers away.

Bellville Recommendation:

Urgently conduct a competitive audit around the Bellville catchment area. A Groceries decline of –31.6% and Electronics decline of –33.6% simultaneously suggests a large-format competitor (e.g. Shoprite, Woolworths Food, or a new Pick n Pay) opened nearby in late 2024 or early 2025.

February 2025 is the inflection point. Investigate what changed in the Bellville area between November 2024 and February 2025.

June 2025 shows a small reversal — do not discount this, but one month is not a trend.

4. Deep Dive — Mega Paarl Central & Mega Tygervalley

4.1 Mega Paarl Central — Category Breakdown

Category	H1 2024	H1 2025	Change (R)	Change (%)
Groceries	R35,980	R29,949	–R6,031	–16.8%
Apparel	R7,954	R6,464	–R1,490	–18.7%
Household	R14,268	R13,559	–R709	–5.0%
Health & Beauty	R7,747	R7,575	–R172	–2.2%
Electronics	R2,394	R2,532	+R138	+5.8%

4.2 Mega Tygervalley — Category Breakdown

Category	H1 2024	H1 2025	Change (R)	Change (%)
Groceries	R32,661	R29,944	–R2,717	–8.3%
Household	R11,813	R10,148	–R1,665	–14.1%
Apparel	R8,329	R7,829	–R500	–6.0%
Health & Beauty	R5,328	R5,611	+R283	+5.3%
Electronics	R2,198	R2,680	+R482	+21.9%

- Both Mega Paarl (–12.1%) and Mega Tygervalley (–6.8%) share the same pattern as Bellville: Groceries and Household are the primary loss categories.
- Tygervalley's visit count is exactly flat (0.0% change) but revenue dropped –6.8% — meaning customers are visiting the same number of times but spending less per trip. This is a classic basket-size compression problem, likely driven by price sensitivity or product mix shifts at checkout.
- Paarl shows a rare Apparel decline (–18.7%) alongside Groceries, suggesting broader discretionary spending cuts in that catchment area, possibly linked to local economic conditions.
- Electronics is growing at both Paarl (+5.8%) and Tygervalley (+21.9%) — this category is resilient across WC Mega stores. It is only Bellville where Electronics is also declining (–33.6%), reinforcing that Bellville has a unique, severe local problem.

5. Bright Spots — The WC Stores That Are Growing

Four stores are growing strongly in WC. These are important for two reasons: they prove there is no fundamental problem with the Imbewu brand in WC, and they offer a playbook for what is working.

Store	Format	H1 2024	H1 2025	Rev Δ	Basket Δ
Imbewu Express Mitchell's Plain	Express	R5,778	R8,186	+41.7%	+34.9%
Imbewu Express Sea Point	Express	R6,848	R9,020	+31.7%	+31.7%
Imbewu Market Khayelitsha	Market	R22,903	R29,682	+29.6%	+7.7%
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- Mitchell's Plain and Sea Point (Express format) are both growing strongly on both revenue and basket size — small footprint stores in high-traffic or underserved areas are clearly a working model.
- Khayelitsha Market (+29.6%) grew both visits (+20.3%) and basket size (+7.7%) simultaneously — the healthiest growth profile of any store in WC. This is the template to replicate.
- Stellenbosch Central (+10.5%) is the most consistent performer — steady visit growth and rising basket size with no dramatic volatility.

Strategic implication:

The WC growth stores share a profile: Express or Market format, community-anchored locations (Mitchell's Plain, Khayelitsha, Sea Point, Stellenbosch). The declining stores are all large-format Mega stores in more established suburban locations (Bellville, Paarl, Tygervalley).

This raises a format-strategy question for leadership: should future WC investment go into smaller-format, community-anchored stores rather than large Mega sites? The data suggests the market is voting with its feet.

6. Updated Findings — What Has Changed from Week 2

The store-level analysis confirms and sharpens the Week 2 findings. The table below shows how the picture has evolved:

#	Week 2 Finding	Week 3 Update
1	Mega stores are the primary revenue drag in WC	CONFIRMED & REFINED. Bellville (−25.4%) is the single largest problem. Paarl (−12.1%) and Tygervalley (−6.8%) are significant but not critical. Mega Parow is flat (+0.9%) — not all Mega stores are failing equally.
2	Groceries and Household losing share across WC	CONFIRMED. This is concentrated in the three declining Mega stores. Express and Market stores show no Groceries decline — the category loss is format-specific, not province-wide.
3	Silver-tier customers disengaging in WC	STILL VALID. The loyalty tier analysis from Week 2 holds. The store-level data does not contradict it — Silver erosion is likely

		concentrated in the Mega-format stores where basket decline is steepest.
+	NEW — WC decline is concentrated, not broad	Without the 3 Mega stores, WC would be in growth. The 4 growing stores offset R15,000 of the R38,543 gross decline. This fundamentally changes the narrative for Sizwe's exec meeting: this is not "WC is failing," it is "3 stores are failing, and 4 are thriving."

7. Power BI Dashboard — Build Plan

Based on the full investigation (Weeks 1–3), the dashboard will be structured across four pages designed for executive use. Each page answers one focused question.

Pg	Page Title	Key Visuals	Answers the Question
1	Executive Overview	Province revenue comparison (bar); WC vs national trend line; 3 KPI cards (revenue Δ , visits Δ , avg basket Δ)	"How bad is the WC problem, and is it unique to WC?"
2	Store Performance Map	Map of WC stores colour-coded by revenue change; store-level table with H1 YoY; format slicer	"Which specific stores are causing the problem, and which are thriving?"
3	Category & Basket Analysis	Category revenue waterfall (WC); basket size trend by format; Groceries & Household deep-dive bar	"What are customers buying less of, and is this a spend or a mix problem?"
4	Loyalty Tier Health	Silver tier revenue trend line (WC vs national); tier visit frequency bar; basket by tier comparison	"Is the loyalty programme holding up, and which tier needs intervention?"

Note: The Pap Power Promo evaluation (Naledi's request) will be included as a tooltip or drill-through on Page 3 within the Groceries/Maize Meal category breakdown, rather than as a standalone page — keeping the dashboard focused on the core exec question.